

Work Term Report:

**Exploring the Role of ESG in Enhancing Sustainability Practices at Cineplex: Strategies
for Waste and Energy Management**

Shirling Liu (4th Year Statistics Co-op)

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Cineplex Sustainability (Department of Purchasing)

ESG Co-op

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Executive Summary

During my second work term, I held the position of a co-op student in ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) at Cineplex from September 2024 to December 2024 (4 months). As part of the ESG team at Cineplex, I supported sustainability initiatives, including energy management, waste reduction, and ethical governance practices. My primary responsibility was utilizing data-driven insights to enhance these initiatives. This experience has significantly enriched my understanding of ESG's mission and allowed me to apply theoretical knowledge from university to real-world situations, contributing significantly to my professional development.

Introduction

The purpose of writing this work term report is two-fold: first, to provide a comprehensive overview of my experiences and achievements while being a coop student at the ESG, and second, to document what I have learned during this four-month internship and the ability to gain refinement. The rationale for these goals is rooted in the need to document my contributions and growth and critically analyze my work's impact on organizational goals. This report aims to comprehensively understand my role and its importance within the broader context of Cineplex's operations by achieving these objectives. Through reflection and analysis, it attempts to elucidate the rationale behind my critical decisions and actions throughout my career, ultimately contributing to a deeper understanding of the challenges, successes and opportunities encountered.

An Overview of the Work Term

While working in the Cineplex ESG under the Department of Purchasing, I contributed to the department's mission of advancing sustainability initiatives. ESG serves as a central hub for innovative programs designed to leverage energy and waste analysis to support the sustainable development of the company. My role in ESG encompassed various responsibilities, including data preprocessing, analysis, and visualization and developing data-driven solutions to support energy and waste management.

As an ESG co-op, my main responsibility is to clean and analyze data from various sources, including energy and waste databases (such as GOBY and the RTS platform) and spreadsheets (such as Excel or csv files). To process large datasets and apply state-of-the-art statistical techniques to derive meaningful insights, I use Excel and PowerPoint to visualize data and explain trends, patterns, or correlations through charts.

In addition to refining and implementing analytical models and algorithms to optimize data trends, I collaborate with multiple departments within ESG, including the Marketing Department and coworkers from the Purchasing Department, to translate requirements for implementing the company's sustainability development projects into actionable data-driven solutions. Furthermore, I actively participate in meetings with account managers and consultants from waste and energy management partners to collaborate on sustainability initiatives and discuss strategies for improving energy and waste management. Recognizing

the need for sustainable strategies, I prioritize gaining insights into these strategies and providing fundamental analysis based on existing data for multiple Cineplex theatres. These analyses help account managers and consultants gain a shared understanding of how to apply these strategies to improve energy and waste management at Cineplex. Simultaneously, I actively communicate in writing with multiple suppliers at Cineplex to request the completion of questionnaires to assess the ethical performance of suppliers, helping Cineplex manage and improve supply chain sustainability. These experiences refine my data analysis skills and reinforce my dedication to leveraging data-driven insights to drive sustainability success at ESG.

Overall, my work term at Cineplex ESG provided invaluable hands-on experience in data analysis, enabling me to apply the theoretical knowledge gained from coursework to real-world scenarios. It deepened my understanding of energy and waste management while strengthening my knowledge of leveraging data-driven insights to support sustainable development and promote ethical performance in the supply chain.

Analytical Section

Work Term placement

I spent my second work term with the Cineplex ESG team for four months. As the largest cinema operator in Canada, Cineplex was a company I had been familiar with for a long time. Starting my career at such a well-known organization enabled me to quickly adapt to the workplace. Working for Cineplex provided me with a comprehensive understanding of its culture, allowing for a smooth transition into my role and offering valuable opportunities for professional growth.

The internship with the Cineplex ESG team was designed to teach us how to integrate into a professional environment while enhancing essential skills. My supervisor and colleagues were patient and supportive, always willing to guide me through unfamiliar tasks and provide constructive feedback to help me improve. They regularly sought my input when assigning tasks, ensuring alignment with my interests and strengths. Additionally, our regular meetings gave me insights into my colleagues' work, fostering better collaboration and coordination.

This experience was an excellent opportunity to professionally apply my university learning to real-world scenarios. It deepened my understanding of ESG practices and allowed me to gain firsthand experience within an organization I had admired for years, becoming an integral part of its operations.

Work Term Duties and Objectives

As an ESG Co-op within the Department of Purchasing, my primary focus is supporting the implementation of the company's sustainable development projects and monitoring the ethical performance of suppliers in the workplace. My daily responsibilities include collecting data on energy usage (such as electricity and natural gas) and waste management (such as diversion rates), as well as conducting necessary cleaning procedures. Additionally, I create various visualizations using Excel, PowerPoint, and Canva, with a particular emphasis on the Energy Efficiency Measures Analysis. This process involves gathering, cleaning, and analyzing energy data from multiple Cineplex theatres and location-based entertainment venues. The insights generated support sustainability and energy management initiatives, ultimately contributing to the optimization of sustainable development efforts.

I work with various datasets from sustainability and energy management partners, analyzing critical energy and waste evaluations for theatres and location-based entertainment venues. I then visualize this data to help improve the progress of energy and waste efficiency measures. My primary goal is to create user-friendly graphs for teams in theatres and location-based entertainment venues across Canada who have little to no knowledge of energy and waste management. These visuals enhance their understanding of the importance of sustainable development but also transform complex data into concise, comprehensive summaries.

Combining Data Analysis and Visualization Tools: Excel & PowerPoint

Throughout this work term, I gained experience using Excel and PowerPoint. I primarily use Excel as a data cleaning and analysis tool for Cineplex, while PowerPoint is utilized to propose or introduce projects to senior managers (such as the Vice President) and teams from multiple theatres. The reason I use these tools differently lies in their distinct characteristics. Excel, a data cleaning, analyzing, and visualization tool developed by Microsoft, allows users to perform analyses by connecting to multiple data sources. It also offers an online workspace that enables organizations to organize their data and link various sources by importing and integrating information efficiently.

On the other hand, PowerPoint is an online visualization tool also developed by Microsoft, with the limitation of presenting data sources with visualizations but needing advanced analysis functions. However, it excels in creating interactive reports, making it ideal for sharing research findings with colleagues and senior managers. In this context, it is crucial to combine the two tools: using Excel for analysis and PowerPoint for presenting findings in comprehensive reports. This approach ensures that senior managers and colleagues fully understand the proposals and results. Although both software tools can present data visualizations, each has its strengths and weaknesses. There is no perfect solution; the key is to leverage the strengths of both to maximize their advantages.

Interpersonal and Technical Skills Required for a Successful Work Term

A dynamic set of skills and tools is required to effectively fulfill the job duties of an ESG coop in the Department of Purchasing. Firstly, analytical and research skills are essential. Since the primary responsibility of an ESG coop is to analyze data from various sources, it is necessary to deal with different types of data and utilize analytical skills to gain insights into valuable data and make professional decisions regarding optimized data performance and visualization. Strong research skills are crucial for finding new approaches and possible solutions when encountering difficulties or obstacles.

In our hybrid work format, written and verbal communication skills are not just necessary but empowering. When faced with suppliers and meetings, verbal communication is often required, and remote working environments can make contacting colleagues for urgent tasks challenging. However, the ability to effectively verbally communicate and seek guidance from supervisors or colleagues when available makes me capable of handling any situation. Written communication is also essential for tasks that require a deeper understanding of data sources, report purposes, and colleague requirements, often conducted through Teams chat or email. Clear and concise communication enhances our work efficiency and confidence in conveying my ideas. Additionally, the capacity to quickly learn and adapt to new tasks is essential and a testament to my adaptability and efficiency in work execution.

Finally, creativity is not just important—it is essential for inspiring others through our

projects. Effectively and creatively presenting proposals and findings becomes even more challenging when the audience lacks professional knowledge in the subject area. However, creativity ensures that colleagues and supervisors can understand my explanations and concepts through comprehensive data visualizations and PowerPoint presentations.

As co-op students, we should leverage our positive skills to make meaningful contributions to the organization while absorbing as much experience and knowledge as possible from seasoned professionals during the work term. I have effectively applied my refined skills to support ESG and have consistently performed to the best of my ability. Additionally, I have gleaned valuable insights and knowledge from my colleagues, resulting in a mutually beneficial arrangement for both parties.

Interpersonal and Technical Skills Improved throughout this Work Term

In 4 months of working, I have seen considerable growth in my interpersonal and technical skills. First and foremost, my communication skills have notably improved. The workplace demands constant interaction with colleagues, making it an ideal environment to practice and refine verbal and written communication skills.

Teamwork has also become a crucial aspect of my work. Collaborating across different departments and with colleagues has strengthened connections and significantly enhanced the quality and efficiency of our completed tasks. Initially, I took a long time to become familiar with a new project as I needed to adjust to different working styles and thought processes.

However, through participation in various projects alongside coworkers, I have developed the ability to coordinate work effectively within a team environment.

Furthermore, my proficiency in data analysis has significantly advanced. Working with multiple databases has allowed me to explore diverse data collection and analysis methods. For example, in one project, I collected energy data from various Cineplex theatres and location-based entertainment venues. Data collection was performed manually by downloading information from an energy management platform, followed by data cleaning and analysis using Excel. Based on existing data, we collaborated with my supervisor and a consultant to develop strategies to improve and promote sustainable practices across all theatres. Consultants then visited the sites to identify the best solutions for improvement. My primary responsibility was to extrapolate analyses based on their strategies and apply them across theatres and location-based entertainment venues nationwide. This experience enabled me to research various data analysis methods and work with multiple types of energy information (such as electricity and natural gas), enhancing my analytical skills in sustainability.

In summary, the improvements in my communication, teamwork, and data analysis skills have strengthened my capabilities and made valuable contributions to the ESG initiatives.

Application of Work Term to Future Career

As mentioned earlier, I have developed my communication, teamwork, and analytical skills during this work term, which I consider valuable for my future career. However, one aspect I have not highlighted but find equally important is the growth of my confidence, both in the workplace and in my daily life.

I have gradually gained confidence throughout the work term, understanding that it is a continuous process. While there is still ample room for improvement, I am optimistic about becoming more confident, particularly as I gain more experience in subsequent work terms. Additionally, my role as a ESG coop has provided insight into potential career paths post-graduation. This work term has illuminated a promising trajectory for my future career. It has allowed me to navigate the workplace with increased confidence and seamlessly integrate into its dynamics.

Conclusions and Recommendations

In conclusion, my work term with the Cineplex ESG team has been pivotal to my personal and professional development. Starting my career while still at university provided a familiar environment that facilitated a seamless transition into the workplace and offered valuable growth opportunities. The internship emphasized the importance of integrating into the professional environment while honing essential skills, supported by patient and constructive guidance from supervisors and colleagues. Regular meetings and tailored feedback enhanced my understanding of team dynamics and project objectives, fostering better coordination and productivity.

My responsibilities as an ESG Co-op within Cineplex presented diverse challenges, from ensuring data quality to producing insightful reports. Collaborative efforts with suppliers and consultants exemplified ESG's mission to advance sustainable development and promote ethical workplace practices among suppliers. These experiences helped refine both my technical and interpersonal skills.

Looking ahead, I believe the skills and experiences gained during this work term will be crucial in shaping my future career trajectory. Beyond technical proficiency, the confidence and adaptability I have developed will be essential assets in navigating future workplace challenges. As I continue to build on these foundations, I am optimistic about the opportunities ahead and confident in my ability to make meaningful contributions.